



Elementary Latin

COURSE 5007090 • GRADES 3–5 • FULL YEAR • OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE — FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. It was drawn from one section of the course as taught this year, and each teacher leans into their own strengths and passions — so scholars may see some variation in activities, projects, and pacing from section to section, and between the live school and On-Demand. The structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

What this course is: A joyful first encounter with Latin — the language beneath English, science, and the classical tradition. Across the year, students learn how Latin verbs and nouns work, translate their first real sentences, and memorize a growing Latin recitation passage one line at a time. Semester 1 builds verbs and nouns from the ground up; Semester 2 adds adjectives, adverbs, questions, and counting in Latin, ending with constellations and a year-end review of everything learned.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

Mod 1–2	The Latin alphabet & pronunciation; what a verb is — the recitation passage begins
Mod 3–6	Verb endings (-o, -s, -t), principal parts, and first translations • Quarter 1 check-in
Mod 7–12	Nouns: recognizing, grouping, and building complete sentences — full recitation passage mastered
Mod 13–16	<i>Sum</i> means “I am”: the verb “to be,” review weeks • Semester 1 exam: “Show What You Know”
Mod 17–22	Welcome back! Adjectives and adverbs — describing words in Latin, with review
Mod 23–25	Asking and answering questions in Latin
Mod 26–29	Counting! Cardinal & ordinal numbers • Numbers Project
Mod 30–34	Constellations, then a four-week year-end review of verbs, nouns, adjectives & numbers

PROJECTS

- **Recitation passage** — the signature thread of the year: a real Latin passage memorized line by line and performed as it grows (Modules 2–13).
- **Numbers Project** (Module 28) — a creative show-what-you-know piece using Latin numbers.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- **Lesson page** — “Exploring Latin”: the week’s grammar idea, taught step by step
- **Memory work** — the recitation line(s) and chants for the week
- **“Words We Know”** — the weekly vocabulary assignment
- **Practice assignment** — translation or grammar practice
- **Recitation** — recorded practice, then the graded recitation
- **Module quiz** — a short check at the end of most weeks

TIME COMMITMENT

≈ 1½ hours per week (80 minutes — two class days)
Lesson & memory work ≈ 30 min • vocabulary & practice ≈ 25 min • recitation ≈ 15 min • quiz ≈ 10 min

Per-part split is an estimate; the 80-minute weekly total comes from the school’s course plan. Project and review weeks may run a little longer.

WHAT STUDENTS NEED

- A computer with access to Canvas (all lessons, assignments & quizzes live there)
- A way to record recitations (computer microphone is fine)
- Optional fun-practice games (Gimkit, Blooket) are free and teacher-provided

On-Demand (asynchronous): This overview describes the self-paced experience the course is designed for — students work through lessons on their own schedule with an Optima teacher available for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school: Students enrolled in the live virtual school take this same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.